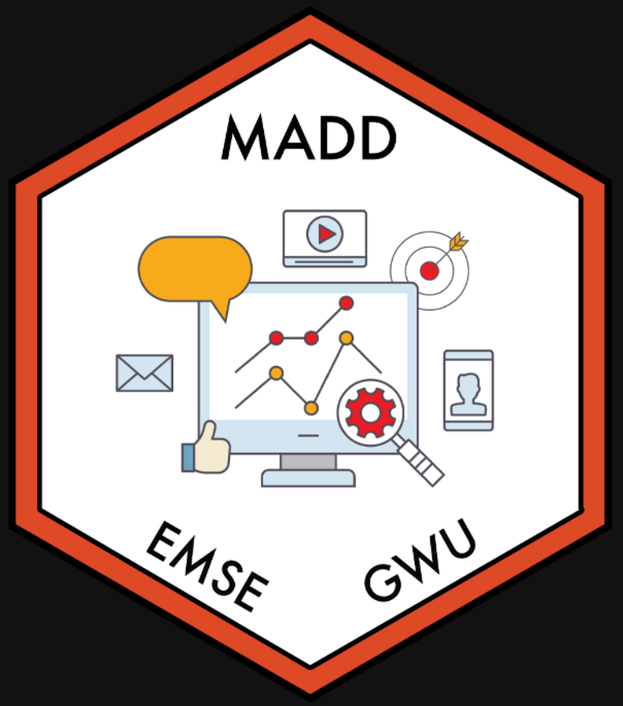


Uncertainty

EMSE 6035: Marketing Analytics for Design Decisions

John Paul Helveston

October 28, 2026

Pilot Analysis Report

Due 11/01 (that’s 4 days from now)

Week 10: *Uncertainty*

1. Computing uncertainty
2. Reshaping data
3. Cleaning pilot data
4. Estimating pilot data models

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Maximum likelihood estimation

$$\tilde{u}_j = \boldsymbol{\beta}'\mathbf{x}_j + \tilde{\varepsilon}_j$$

$$= \beta_1 x_{j1} + \beta_2 x_{j2} + \ldots + \tilde{\varepsilon}_j$$

Weights that denote the *relative* value of attributes $x_{j1}, x_{j2}, \ldots$

Estimate β_1 , β_2 , … , by minimizing the negative log-likelihood function:

$$\text{minimize} - \ln(\mathcal{L}) = -\sum_{j=1}^{J} y_j \ln\left[P_j(\boldsymbol{\beta}|\mathbf{x})\right]$$

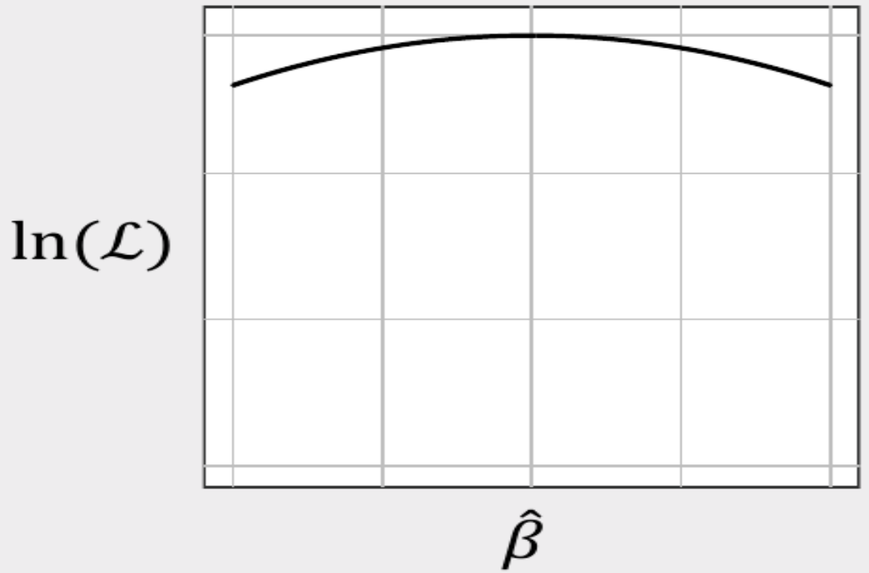
with respect to $\boldsymbol{\beta}$

$y_j = 1$ if alternative j was chosen

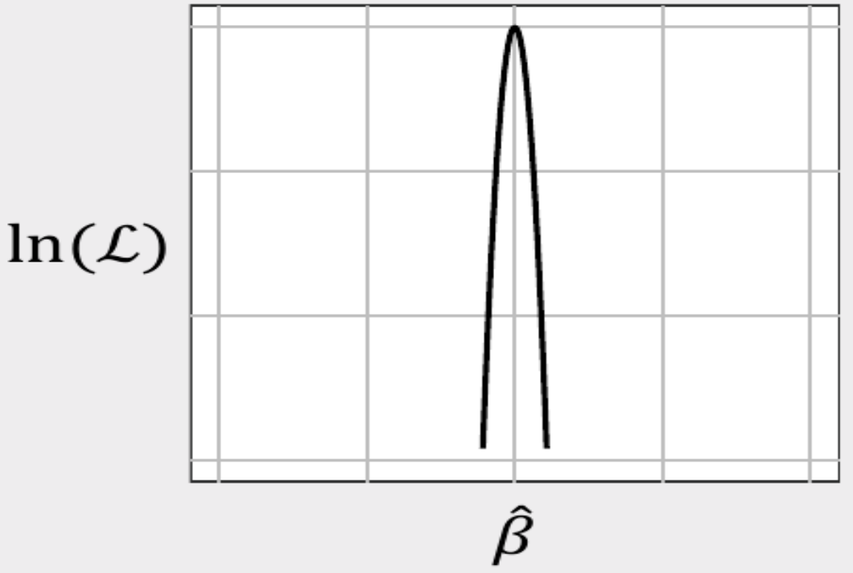
$y_j = 0$ if alternative j was not chosen

The certainty of $\widehat{\boldsymbol{\beta}}$ is inversely related to the curvature of the log-likelihood function

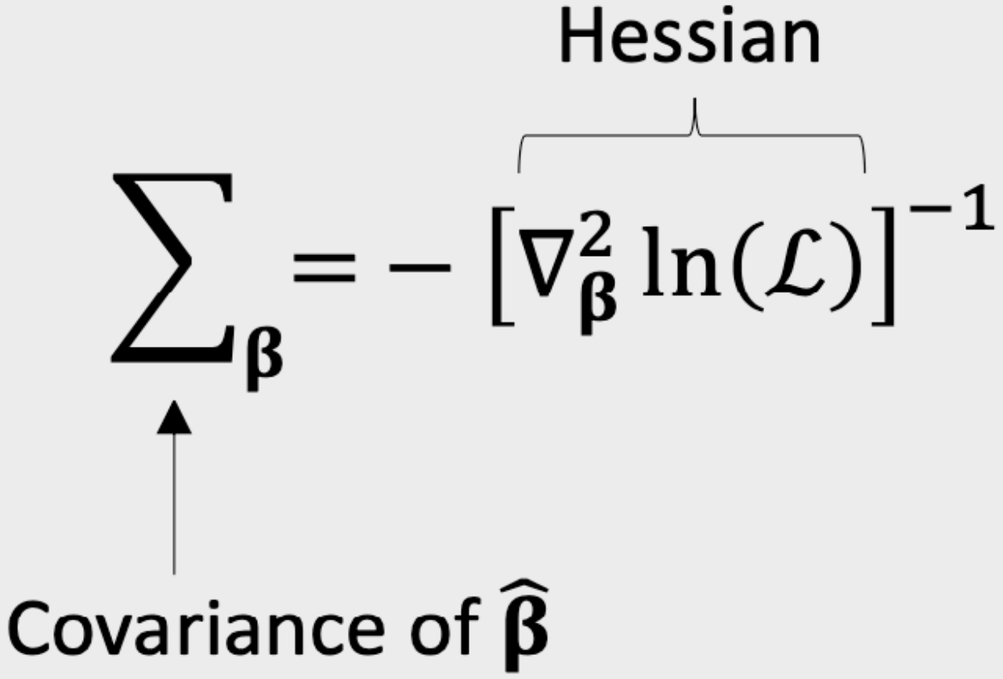
Greater variance in $\ln(\mathcal{L})$,
Less certainty in $\hat{\beta}$



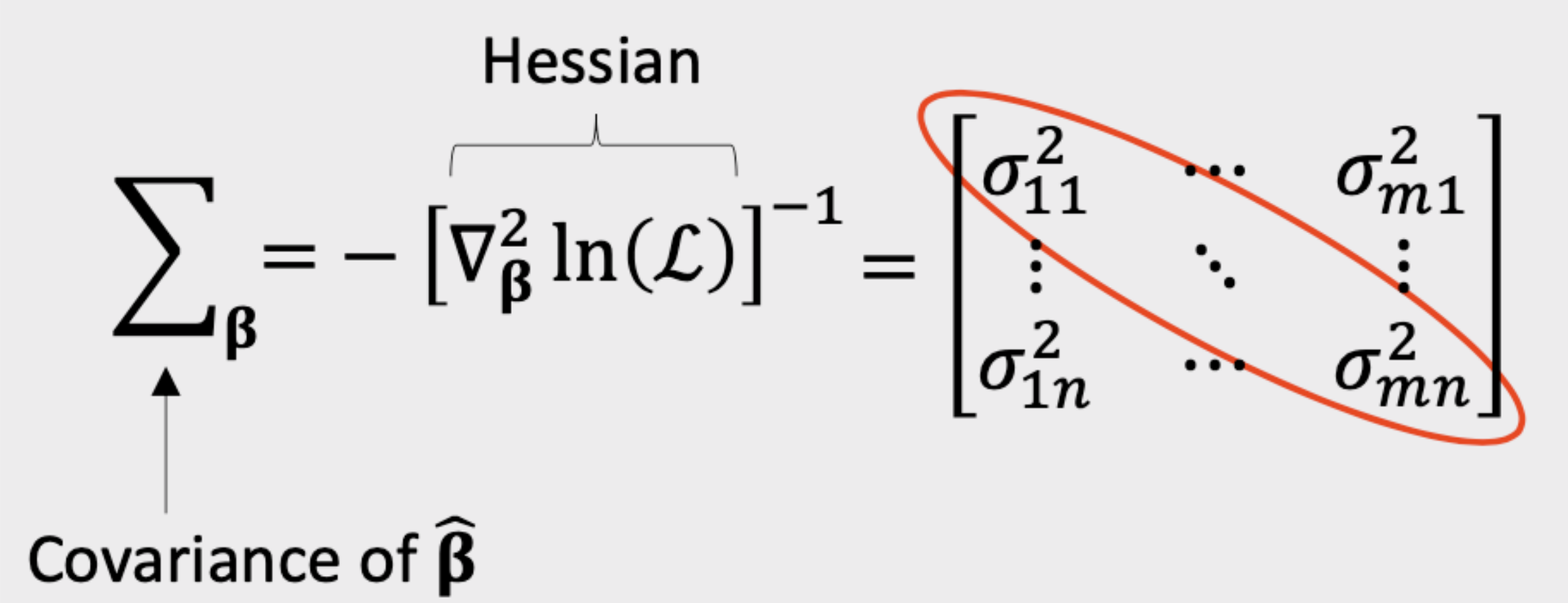
Less variance in $\ln(\mathcal{L})$,
Greater certainty in $\hat{\beta}$



The *curvature* of the log-likelihood function is related to the hessian

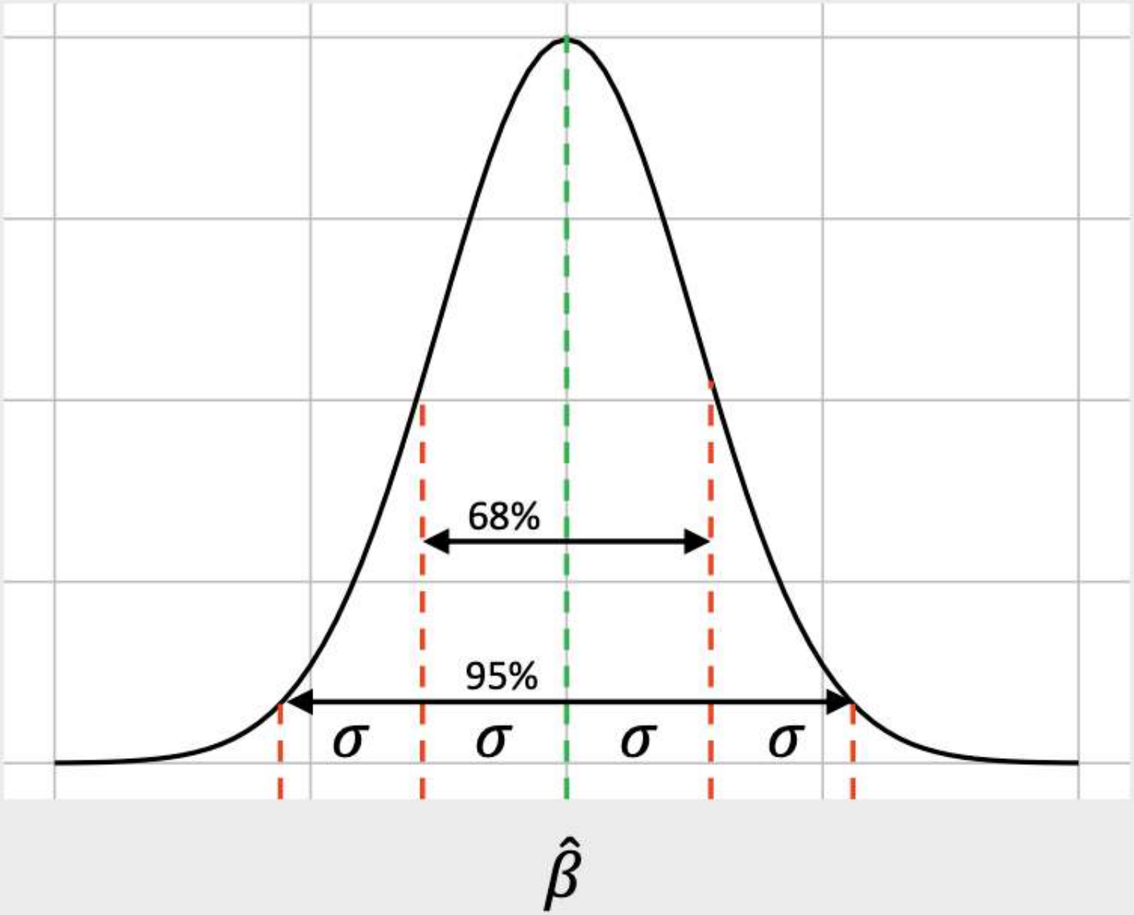


The *curvature* of the log-likelihood function is related to the hessian



Usually report parameter uncertainty ("standard errors") with σ values

Est.	Std. Err.
$\hat{\beta}_1$	σ_1
$\hat{\beta}_2$	σ_2
$\vdots$	$\vdots$
$\hat{\beta}_m$	σ_m



A 95% confidence interval is approximately $[\hat{\beta} - 2\sigma, \hat{\beta} + 2\sigma]$

Practice Question 1

Suppose we estimate a model and get the following results:

$$\hat{\beta} = \begin{bmatrix} -0.4 \\ 0.5 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\nabla^2_{\beta} \ln(\mathcal{L}) = \begin{bmatrix} -6000 & 60 \\ 60 & -700 \end{bmatrix}$$

a. Use the hessian to compute the standard errors for $\hat{\beta}$

b. Use the standard errors to compute a 95% confidence interval around $\hat{\beta}$

Simulating uncertainty

We can use the coefficients and hessian from a model to obtain draws that reflect parameter uncertainty

```
beta <- c(-0.7, 0.1, -4.0)

hessian <- matrix(c(
    -6000,   50,   60,
       50, -700,   50,
       60,   50, -300),
    ncol = 3, byrow = TRUE)
```

```
covariance <- -1*solve(hessian)
draws <- MASS::mvrnorm(
  10^5, beta, covariance
)

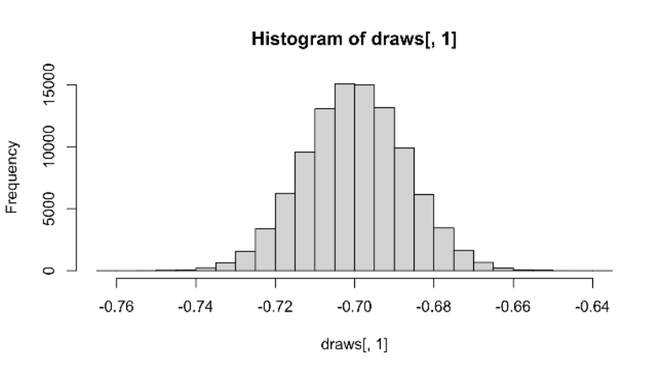
head(draws)
```

```
#>              [,1]       [,2]       [,3]
#> [1,] -0.6911536 0.10922755 -3.981369
#> [2,] -0.7107502 0.07416692 -3.981956
#> [3,] -0.6780508 0.08397502 -3.916559
#> [4,] -0.6997417 0.08142976 -4.041525
#> [5,] -0.7106325 0.09235613 -3.966221
#> [6,] -0.6873777 0.12248389 -3.999070
```

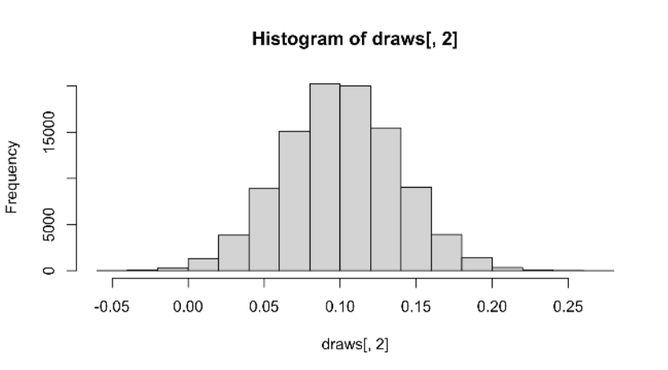
Simulating uncertainty

We can use the coefficients and hessian from a model to obtain draws that reflect parameter uncertainty

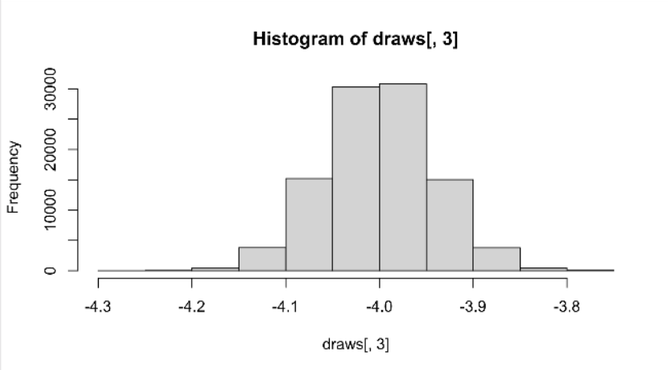
```
1 hist(draws[, 1])
```




```
1 hist(draws[, 2])
```




```
1 hist(draws[, 3])
```



Practice Question 2

Suppose we estimate the following utility model describing preferences for cars:

$$u_j = \alpha p_j + \beta_1 x_j^{mpg} + \beta_2 x_j^{elec} + \varepsilon_j$$

a. Generate 10,000 draws of the model coefficients using the estimated coefficients and hessian. Use the `mvrnorm()` function from the `MASS` library.

b. Use the draws to compute the mean and 95% confidence intervals of each parameter estimate.

The estimated model produces the following results:

Parameter	Coefficient
α	-0.7
β_1	0.1
β_2	-0.4

Hessian:

$$\begin{bmatrix} -6000 & 50 & 60 \\ 50 & -700 & 50 \\ 60 & 50 & -300 \end{bmatrix}$$

Download the logitr-cars repo from GitHub

Computing and visualizing uncertainty

1. Open `logitr-cars`
2. Open `code/5.1-uncertainty.R`

Week 10: *Uncertainty*

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Federal R&D Spending by Department

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 15
#>    year   DHS   DOC   DOD   DOE   DOT   EPA   HHS Interior  NASA   NIH   NSF Of
#>   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>    <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <d
#> 1  1976     0   819 35696 10882  1142   968  9226     1152 12513  8025  2372  1
#> 2  1977     0   837 37967 13741  1095   966  9507     1082 12553  8214  2395  1
#> 3  1978     0   871 37022 15663  1156  1175 10533     1125 12516  8802  2446  1
#> 4  1979     0   952 37174 15612  1004  1102 10127     1176 13079  9243  2404  1
#> 5  1980     0   945 37005 15226  1048   903 10045     1082 13837  9093  2407  1
#> 6  1981     0   829 41737 14798   978   901  9644      990 13276  8580  2300  1
```

Federal R&D Spending by Department

“Wide” format

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 15
#>    year   DHS   DOC   DOD   DOE   DOT   EPA   HHS Interior  NASA
#>   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>    <dbl> <dbl>
#> 1  1976     0   819 35696 10882  1142   968  9226     1152 12513
#> 2  1977     0   837 37967 13741  1095   966  9507     1082 12553
#> 3  1978     0   871 37022 15663  1156  1175 10533     1125 12516
#> 4  1979     0   952 37174 15612  1004  1102 10127     1176 13079
#> 5  1980     0   945 37005 15226  1048   903 10045     1082 13837
#> 6  1981     0   829 41737 14798   978   901  9644      990 13276
```

“Long” format

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 3
#>   department  year rd_budget_mil
#>   <chr>      <dbl>         <dbl>
#> 1 DOD         1976         35696
#> 2 NASA        1976         12513
#> 3 DOE         1976         10882
#> 4 HHS         1976          9226
#> 5 NIH         1976          8025
#> 6 NSF         1976          2372
```

Federal R&D Spending by Department

“Wide” format

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 15
#>    year   DHS   DOC   DOD   DOE   DOT   EPA   HHS Interior  NASA
#>   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>    <dbl> <dbl>
#> 1  1976     0   819 35696 10882  1142   968  9226     1152 12513
#> 2  1977     0   837 37967 13741  1095   966  9507     1082 12553
#> 3  1978     0   871 37022 15663  1156  1175 10533     1125 12516
#> 4  1979     0   952 37174 15612  1004  1102 10127     1176 13079
#> 5  1980     0   945 37005 15226  1048   903 10045     1082 13837
#> 6  1981     0   829 41737 14798   978   901  9644      990 13276
```

```
#> [1] 42 15
```

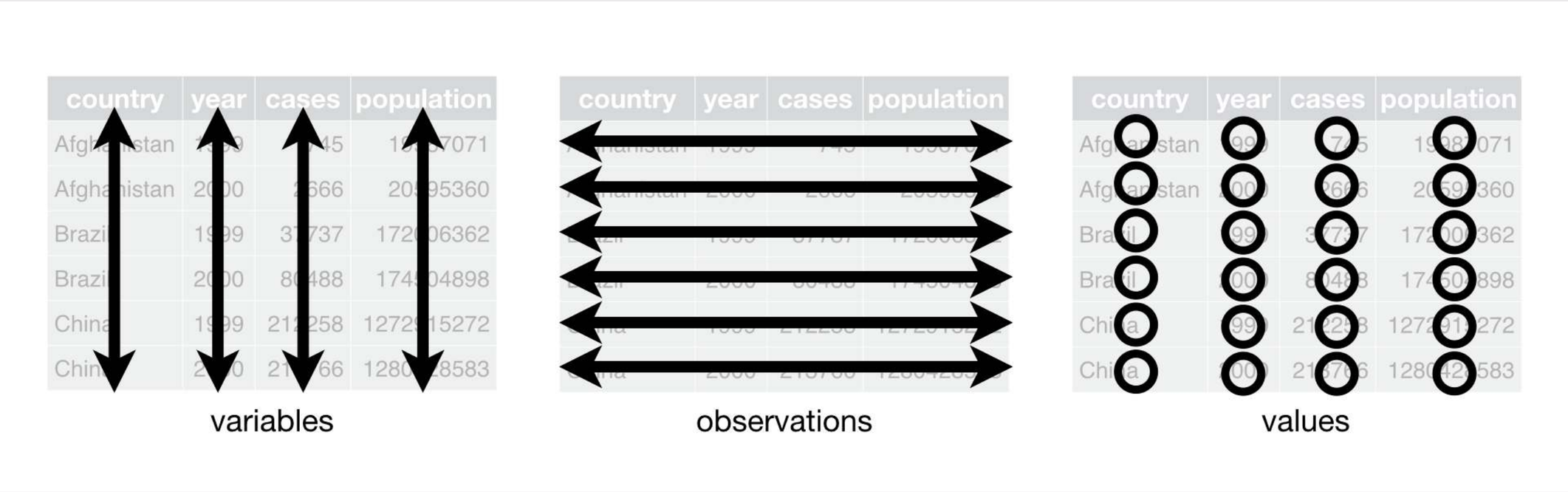
“Long” format

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 3
#>   department  year rd_budget_mil
#>   <chr>      <dbl>         <dbl>
#> 1 DOD         1976         35696
#> 2 NASA        1976         12513
#> 3 DOE         1976         10882
#> 4 HHS         1976          9226
#> 5 NIH         1976          8025
#> 6 NSF         1976          2372
```

```
#> [1] 588   3
```

Tidy data = “Long” format

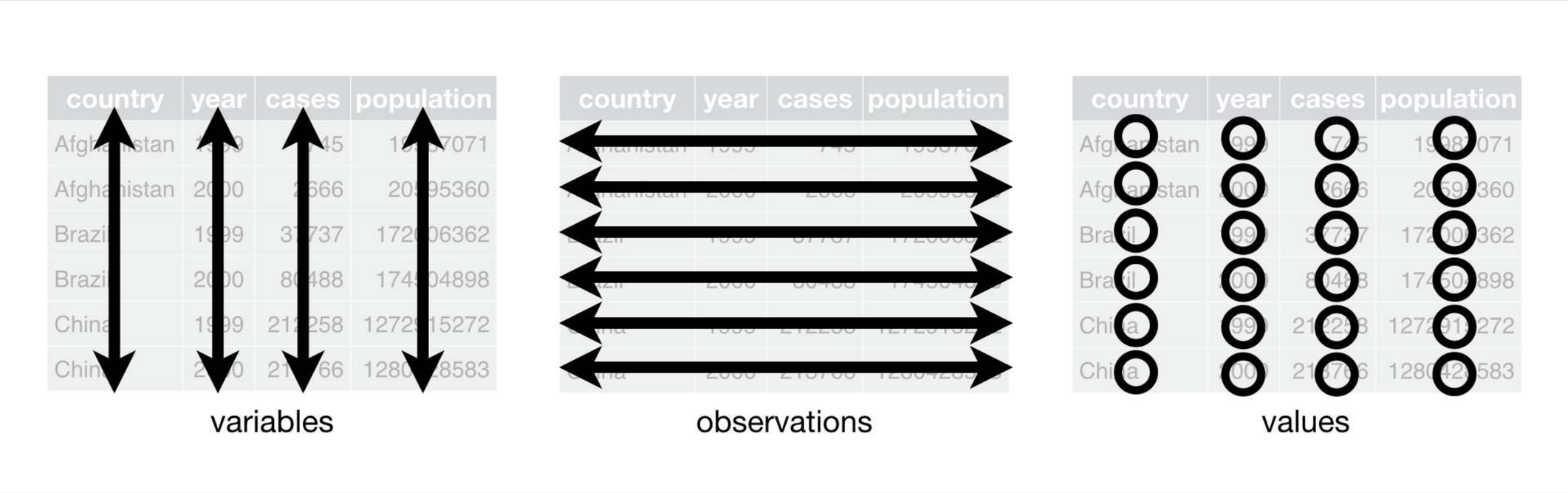
- Each **variable** has its own **column**
- Each **observation** has its own **row**



Tidy data

- Each **variable** has its own **column**
- Each **observation** has its own **row**

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 3
#>   department  year rd_budget_mil
#>   <chr>      <dbl>          <dbl>
#> 1 DOD         1976          35696
#> 2 NASA        1976          12513
#> 3 DOE         1976          10882
#> 4 HHS         1976           9226
#> 5 NIH         1976           8025
#> 6 NSF         1976           2372
```



“Long” format

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 3
#>   department  year rd_budget_mil
#>   <chr>      <dbl>         <dbl>
#> 1 DOD         1976         35696
#> 2 NASA        1976         12513
#> 3 DOE         1976         10882
#> 4 HHS         1976          9226
#> 5 NIH         1976          8025
#> 6 NSF         1976          2372
```

“Wide” format

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 15
#>    year   DHS   DOC   DOD   DOE   DOT   EPA   HHS Interior  NASA
#>   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>    <dbl> <dbl>
#> 1  1976     0   819 35696 10882  1142   968  9226     1152 12513
#> 2  1977     0   837 37967 13741  1095   966  9507     1082 12553
#> 3  1978     0   871 37022 15663  1156  1175 10533     1125 12516
#> 4  1979     0   952 37174 15612  1004  1102 10127     1176 13079
#> 5  1980     0   945 37005 15226  1048   903 10045     1082 13837
#> 6  1981     0   829 41737 14798   978   901  9644      990 13276
```

Do the names describe the values?

Yes: “Long” format

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 3
#>   department  year rd_budget_mil
#>   <chr>      <dbl>         <dbl>
#> 1 DOD         1976         35696
#> 2 NASA        1976         12513
#> 3 DOE         1976         10882
#> 4 HHS         1976          9226
#> 5 NIH         1976          8025
#> 6 NSF         1976          2372
```

No: “Wide” format

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 8
#>    year   DHS   DOC   DOD   DOE   DOT   EPA   HHS
#>   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
#> 1  1976     0   819 35696 10882  1142   968  9226
#> 2  1977     0   837 37967 13741  1095   966  9507
#> 3  1978     0   871 37022 15663  1156  1175 10533
#> 4  1979     0   952 37174 15612  1004  1102 10127
#> 5  1980     0   945 37005 15226  1048   903 10045
#> 6  1981     0   829 41737 14798   978   901  9644
```

Quick practice 1: “long” or “wide” format?

Description: Tuberculosis cases in various countries

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 4
#>   country      year  cases population
#>   <chr>       <dbl>  <dbl>      <dbl>
#> 1 Afghanistan  1999    745   19987071
#> 2 Afghanistan  2000   2666   20595360
#> 3 Brazil       1999  37737  172006362
#> 4 Brazil       2000  80488  174504898
#> 5 China        1999 212258 1272915272
#> 6 China        2000 213766 1280428583
```

Quick practice 2: “long” or “wide” format?

Description: Word counts in LOTR trilogy

```
#> # A tibble: 9 × 4
#>   Film                      Race   Female  Male
#>   <chr>                     <chr>   <dbl> <dbl>
#> 1 The Fellowship Of The Ring Elf      1229   971
#> 2 The Fellowship Of The Ring Hobbit     14  3644
#> 3 The Fellowship Of The Ring Man         0  1995
#> 4 The Return Of The King     Elf       183   510
#> 5 The Return Of The King     Hobbit      2  2673
#> 6 The Return Of The King     Man       268  2459
#> 7 The Two Towers             Elf       331   513
#> 8 The Two Towers             Hobbit      0  2463
#> 9 The Two Towers             Man       401  3589
```

Quick practice 3: “long” or “wide” format?

Description: Word counts in LOTR trilogy

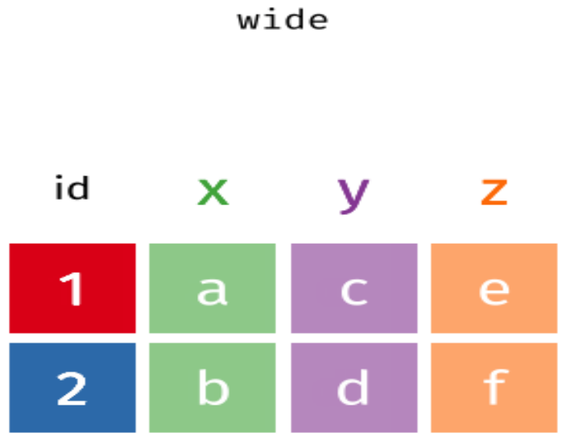
```
#> # A tibble: 15 × 4
#>    Film                      Race   Gender Word_Count
#>    <chr>                     <chr>  <chr>       <dbl>
#>  1 The Fellowship Of The Ring Elf    Female       1229
#>  2 The Fellowship Of The Ring Elf    Male          971
#>  3 The Fellowship Of The Ring Hobbit Female         14
#>  4 The Fellowship Of The Ring Hobbit Male         3644
#>  5 The Fellowship Of The Ring Man    Female          0
#>  6 The Fellowship Of The Ring Man    Male         1995
#>  7 The Return Of The King     Elf    Female        183
#>  8 The Return Of The King     Elf    Male          510
#>  9 The Return Of The King     Hobbit Female          2
#> 10 The Return Of The King     Hobbit Male         2673
#> 11 The Return Of The King     Man    Female        268
#> 12 The Return Of The King     Man    Male         2459
#> 13 The Two Towers             Elf    Female        331
#> 14 The Two Towers             Elf    Male          513
#> 15 The Two Towers             Hobbit Female          0
```

Reshaping data with

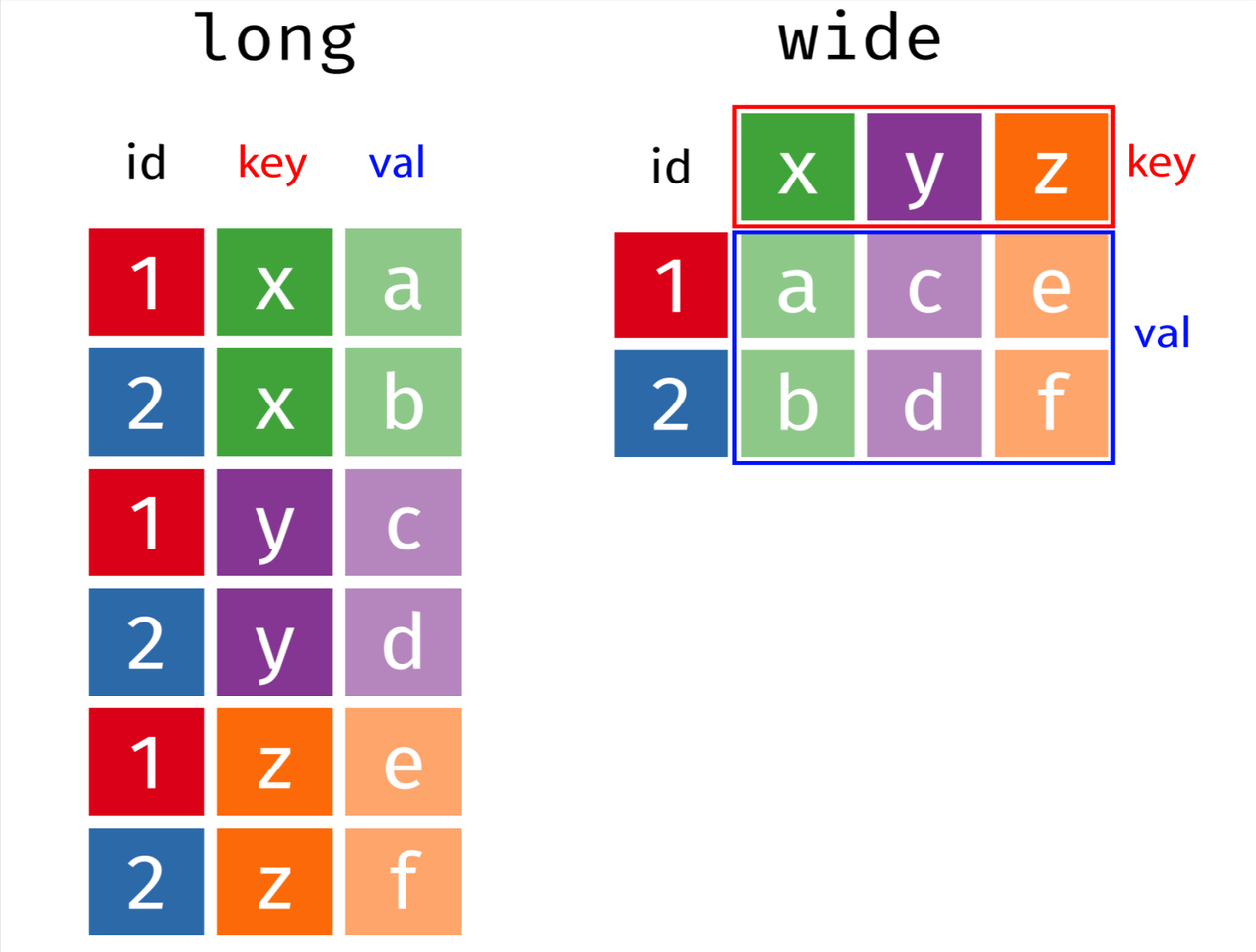
`pivot_longer()` and `pivot_wider()`

Reshaping data

`pivot_longer()`
`pivot_wider()`



From “long” to “wide” with `pivot_wider()`



From “long” to “wide” with `pivot_wider()`

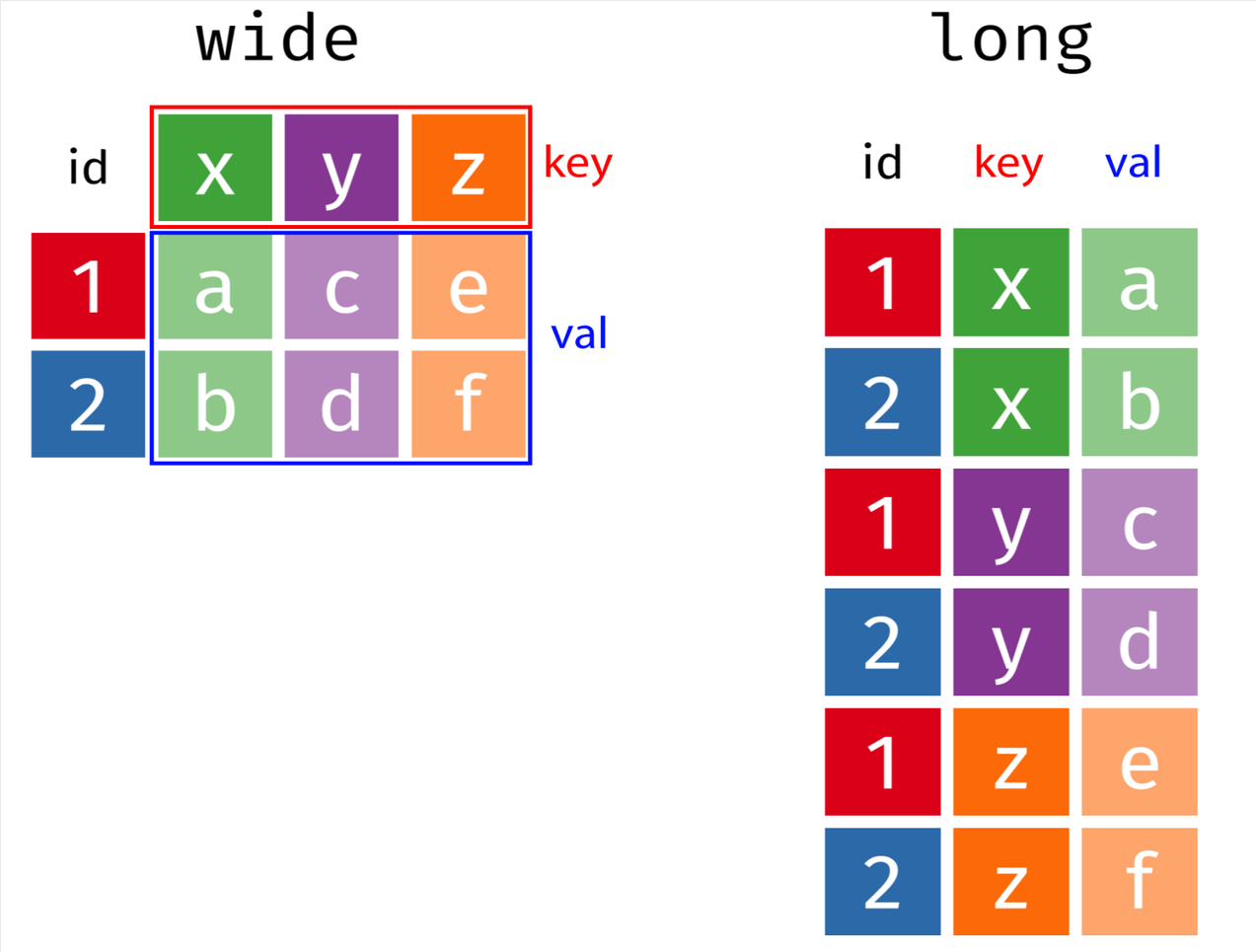
```
1  head(fed_spend_long)
```

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 3
#>   department  year rd_budget_mil
#>   <chr>      <dbl>          <dbl>
#> 1 DOD         1976          35696
#> 2 NASA        1976          12513
#> 3 DOE         1976          10882
#> 4 HHS         1976           9226
#> 5 NIH         1976           8025
#> 6 NSF         1976           2372
```

```
1  fed_spend_wide <- fed_spend_long %>%
2      pivot_wider(
3          names_from = department,
4          values_from = rd_budget_mil)
5
6  head(fed_spend_wide)
```

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 15
#>    year   DOD  NASA   DOE   HHS   NIH    
#>   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <d
#> 1  1976 35696 12513 10882  9226  8025  2
#> 2  1977 37967 12553 13741  9507  8214  2
#> 3  1978 37022 12516 15663 10533  8802  2
#> 4  1979 37174 13079 15612 10127  9243  2
#> 5  1980 37005 13837 15226 10045  9093  2
#> 6  1981 41737 13276 14798  9644  8580  2
```

From “wide” to “long” with `pivot_longer()`



From “wide” to “long” with `pivot_longer()`

```
1  head(fed_spend_wide)
```

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 15
#>    year   DOD  NASA   DOE   HHS
#>   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
#> 1  1976 35696 12513 10882  9226
#> 2  1977 37967 12553 13741  9507
#> 3  1978 37022 12516 15663 10533
#> 4  1979 37174 13079 15612 10127
#> 5  1980 37005 13837 15226 10045
#> 6  1981 41737 13276 14798  9644
```

```
1  fed_spend_long <- fed_spend_wide %>%
2      pivot_longer(
3          names_to = "department",
4          values_to = "rd_budget_mil",
5          cols = DOD:Other)
6
7  head(fed_spend_long)
```

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 3
#>    year department rd_budget_mil
#>   <dbl> <chr>                <dbl>
#> 1  1976 DOD                  35696
#> 2  1976 NASA                 12513
#> 3  1976 DOE                  10882
#> 4  1976 HHS                   9226
#> 5  1976 NIH                   8025
#> 6  1976 NSF                   2372
```

Can also set `cols` by selecting which columns *not* to use

```
1 names(fed_spend_wide)
```

```
#>  [1] "year"       "DOD"        "NASA
```

```
1 fed_spend_long <- fed_spend_wide %>%
2     pivot_longer(
3         names_to = "department",
4         values_to = "rd_budget_mil",
5         cols = -year)
6
7 head(fed_spend_long)
```

```
#> # A tibble: 6 × 3
#>    year department rd_budget_mil
#>   <dbl> <chr>                <dbl>
#> 1  1976 DOD                  35696
#> 2  1976 NASA                 12513
#> 3  1976 DOE                  10882
#> 4  1976 HHS                   9226
#> 5  1976 NIH                   8025
#> 6  1976 NSF                   2372
```

Your turn: Reshaping Data

15:00

Open the `practice.qmd` file.

Run the code chunk to read in the following two data files:

- `pv_cell_production.xlsx`: Data on solar photovoltaic cell production by country
- `milk_production.csv`: Data on milk production by state

Now modify the format of each:

- If the data are in “wide” format, convert it to “long” with `pivot_longer()`
- If the data are in “long” format, convert it to “wide” with `pivot_wider()`

Break

05:00

Week 10: *Uncertainty*

1. Computing uncertainty
2. Reshaping data
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Download the conjoint_buttons template repo

Cleaning surveydown survey data

1. Open the `template_conjoint_buttons-main` folder in Positron

2. Open `code/3_data_cleaning.R`

Your Turn

20:00

As a team, pick up where you left off last week and create a `choiceData` data frame in a “long” format

Week 10: *Uncertainty*

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Estimating pilot data models

1. Open the `template_conjoint_buttons-main` folder in Positron
2. Open `code/4_modeling.R`

Your Turn

As a team:

1. Use your `choiceData` data frame to estimate preliminary choice models.
2. Interpret your model coefficients **with uncertainty**.